

The Blueprint: Global Automated Mesh

A Complete Deployment Guide by Nathaniel Edet

Phase 1: Local Environment Setup

Before running the automation, you need a local workspace and the necessary security credentials.

Step 1: Generate SSH Keys

Open your terminal and create a dedicated key pair for this project. This allows Ansible to talk to your AWS instance securely.

```
ssh-keygen -t rsa -b 4096 -f ./final-key
```

Add **final-key** and **final-key.pub** to your **.gitignore** to keep them private.

Phase 2: Infrastructure as Code (Terraform)

This creates the virtual "house" where your application will live.

1. terraform/main.tf

```
resource "aws_instance" "mesh_worker" {
  ami           = "ami-0c55b159cbfafa1f0" # Ubuntu 22.04
  instance_type = "t2.micro"
  key_name      = aws_key_pair.final-key.key_name
  vpc_security_group_ids = [aws_security_group.mesh_sg.id]
```

```
tags = { Name = "mesh-worker-node" }  
}  
  
output "public_ip" {  
  value = aws_instance.mesh_worker.public_ip  
}
```

Phase 3: Configuration Management (Ansible)

This installs the "furniture" (Docker and Kubernetes) inside your house.

1. ansible/inventory.ini

```
[webserver]  
target_server ansible_host={{ TARGET_IP }} ansible_user=ubuntu
```

2. ansible/setup.yml (Partial)

```
- name: Setup Mesh Node  
  hosts: webserver  
  become: yes  
  tasks:  
    - name: Install K3s  
      shell: curl -sfL https://get.k3s.io | sh -  
  
    - name: Wait for K3s to initialize  
      pause: seconds=15
```

Phase 4: The CI/CD Pipeline (GitHub Actions)

This is the "brain" that connects everything. Save this as **.github/workflows/deploy.yml**.

```
name: "Global Mesh Deployment"  
on: [push]  
jobs:  
  deploy:  
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
```

```
steps:
  - uses: actions/checkout@v4
  - name: Terraform Init & Apply
    run: |
      cd terraform
      terraform init
      terraform apply -auto-approve
      echo "NEW_IP=$(terraform output -raw public_ip)" >> $GITHUB_ENV
  - name: Run Ansible
    run: |
      echo "${{ secrets.SSH_PRIVATE_KEY }}" > ./final-key
      chmod 400 ./final-key
      ansible-playbook -i ansible/inventory.ini ansible/setup.yml \
        --extra-vars "TARGET_IP=${{ env.NEW_IP }}" --private-key ./final-key
```

Phase 5: Post-Deployment Manual Verification

Once the pipeline is green, SSH into your server to verify the Kubernetes pods.

```
ssh -i ./final-key ubuntu@<YOUR_IP>
sudo kubectl get nodes
sudo kubectl get pods
```